

Historical Web Monitor — Closeout and Modern Successor

Historical repository status

The historical Perl repository, `sobulo-web-monitor-2004`, is now closed at a stable reconstruction point. The Appendix A source from the 2004 thesis has been preserved, audited, and exercised through a controlled local researcher-monitoring flow: page retrieval, publication-link filtering, timestamped snapshots, comparison of two snapshots, and reporting of a previously observed link as missing and a new link as added.

The repository deliberately stops short of recreating the entire historical application. Chapter 4 describes presentation and orchestration components such as a GUI/controller, scheduling, configuration management, notification behavior, and a separate course-monitoring path. Those components are documented as historical boundaries rather than rebuilt here.

Continuing the historical line

Anyone who wants to continue the historical project can fork `sobulo-web-monitor-2004` and add the missing application layers around the preserved backend. A continuation could provide a desktop or web interface for configuration and reports, add scheduling and notification orchestration, or reconstruct the thesis-described course-monitoring behavior. Any such work should remain clearly separated from the frozen Appendix A transcription and identified as new reconstruction.

Modern successor: `web-monitor`

The modern follow-on project will live in a separate repository named `web-monitor`.

`web-monitor` will be a Python implementation inspired by the historical monitoring system rather than a line-for-line port. Its basic purpose is to accept monitoring inputs through a usable interface, run modern monitoring and comparison logic, and present the resulting outputs through an interface suitable for viewing and working with detected changes.

Keeping the modern implementation in a separate repository preserves a clean distinction between the 2004 artifact and new engineering work.